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Chapter 2

Using The JBA InfoBase



Overview

If you are new to the JBA InfoBase, choose InfoBase Basics. Use the scroll bar to view information not visible in the InfoBase window.

To choose a Topic, either:

- Click the underlined topic you want to view.
- Press TAB to select the topic, and then press **Enter**.

InfoBase Basics

The JBA InfoBase offers a quick way to find information, such as how to perform a particular task. Within a Topic, there may be one or more jumps, which you can click (or select and press **Enter**) to display a new Topic. You can move, resize, maximize, or minimize the InfoBase window, just like any other window.

To return to the Contents topic, choose the Contents button.

InfoBase Icons

There are a number of icons used within the JBA InfoBase to give visual cues to the user. These are:



Tip: This symbol represents a helpful tip in the text.



Action: This symbol represents a process which you perform to move on to the next step.



Note: This symbol represents a note in the text.



Warning: This box holds a warning message!

How To...

The following sections explain more about using the InfoBase.

Annotate A Topic

You can add your own comments to a topic. When you annotate a topic, InfoBase places a paper-clip icon to the left of the topic title to remind you that you have added text to this topic. For help on annotating topics, choose one of the following topics:

Adding Text To A Topic

You can add your own comments and notes to a Topic and view this information later.

To add text to the current topic:

1. From the Edit menu in InfoBase, choose Annotate.
2. In the Annotate dialog box, type the text you want to add. If you make a mistake, press Backspace to remove any unwanted characters, and continue typing. Text wraps automatically, but you can end a line before it wraps by pressing **Enter**.
3. Choose the Save button.

Copying And Pasting An Annotation

You can copy text from an annotation and paste it into another annotation in InfoBase or into a document. You can also paste text from documents into annotations. If you no longer need your comments about a Topic, you can remove the annotation.

To copy an annotation:

1. Click the paper-clip icon () to the left of the topic title. Or press TAB to select the paper-clip icon, and then press **Enter**.
2. To copy the annotation to the Clipboard, choose the Copy button. If you want to copy only a portion of the annotation, select the text that you want to copy, and then choose the Copy button. You can drag the mouse pointer over text to select it. Or press and hold down Shift while you use the arrow keys to select text.
3. Choose the Save button.

To paste an annotation:

1. Copy onto the Clipboard the text you want to paste into the annotation.
2. In the Topic where you want to paste the annotation, click the paper-clip icon to the left of the title. Or press TAB to select the paper-clip icon, and then press **Enter**.
3. To paste the contents of the Clipboard at the beginning of the topic, choose the Paste button. Or press SHIFT+INS. Or place the insertion point where you want to insert the new text, and then choose the Paste button.
4. Choose the Save button.

To remove an annotation:

1. Click the paper-clip icon to the left of the topic title. Or press TAB to select the paper-clip icon, and then press **Enter**.
2. Choose the Delete button.

Viewing an Annotation

If you have added comments to a Topic, you can view them at any time.

To view an annotation:

1. Click the paper-clip icon to the left of the topic title. Or press TAB to select the paper-clip icon, and then press **Enter**.
2. When you finish viewing the annotation, choose the Cancel button.

Topics can include graphics and text that link to other Topics or to more information about the current topic. These are called jumps.

Jumps are usually identified by a color and an underline (unless the jump is a graphic). When you point to a jump, the pointer changes to a hand shape.

To choose a jump: point to the text or graphic, and click with the mouse button. Or press TAB to select the jump, and then press **Enter**. You can press Shift+TAB to move backward and select a jump.

If the jump you choose is linked to another topic, that topic appears in the InfoBase window. Sometimes a jump is linked to information that appears in a pop up window or a secondary window.



Note: When information is displayed in a pop up window, the size of the pop up window is proportional to the size of the main InfoBase window. If you want the pop up window to be larger, you need to change the size of the main InfoBase window.

To display all jumps in a topic, press CTRL+TAB.

To close a pop up window: click anywhere on the screen, or press any key.

To close a secondary window: double-click the Control-menu box. Or press ALT-SPACEBAR to open the Control menu, and then choose Close.

Copy A Topic Onto The Clipboard

You can copy some or all of the text in a Topic onto the Clipboard. From the Clipboard, you can paste the text into another document.



Note: You cannot copy the graphics in a Topic onto the Clipboard.

To copy text in the current Topic onto the Clipboard:

1. From the Edit menu in InfoBase, choose Copy.
2. To copy all the text onto the Clipboard, choose the Copy button. Or select the text you want to copy onto the Clipboard, and then choose the Copy button.

You can paste the text that is on the Clipboard into a InfoBase annotation or into a document from another application.

To copy text in the current Topic onto the Clipboard, press CTRL+INS.

Define And Use Bookmarks

Just as you can place bookmarks in a book to mark specific references, you can place bookmarks in Topics you use frequently. After you have placed a bookmark in a topic, you can access that topic quickly from the Bookmark menu.

To place a bookmark in the current topic:

1. From the Bookmark menu in InfoBase, choose Define.
2. In the Bookmark Name box, the topic title appears. If you want to use a different name to identify the bookmark, type a name in this box.
3. Choose the OK button.

The bookmark name now appears on the Bookmark menu in InfoBase.

To view a topic that has a bookmark, from the Bookmark menu in InfoBase, choose the bookmark name for the topic you want to view.

Underlined numbers precede the first nine bookmark titles. You can type the corresponding number to go quickly to a marked topic.

If more than nine bookmarks have been defined, choose More from the Bookmark menu in InfoBase. Select a bookmark in the Go To Bookmark box, and then choose the OK button.

To remove a bookmark:

1. From the Bookmark menu in InfoBase, choose Define.
2. Select the bookmark you want to remove.
3. Choose the Delete button.

The bookmark name is removed from the Bookmark menu in InfoBase.

Getting Help From JBA Applications

You can access InfoBase while using an application by choosing a command from the application's Help menu or by pressing **F1**.

To access InfoBase from an application: from the Help menu in the application, choose a Help command or press **F1** while using the application.

InfoBase appears. The topic that is displayed depends on which screen was displayed when you pressed **F1**. With some applications, the Contents for the application appears. With other applications, a Topic on the selected screen appears.



Note: If F1 does not display InfoBase, you must use the application's Help menu.

Keeping InfoBase On Top Of Other Windows

When you first open InfoBase it appears on top of other windows. If you select another window, it might cover up the InfoBase window.

You can choose to keep the InfoBase window on top of other windows even when you switch to other applications. This can be useful if you are using InfoBase to follow a step-by-step procedure in your application.



Note: If you minimize an InfoBase window that is on top, its icon also appears on top of other windows.

To keep the InfoBase window on top:

From the Help menu in the InfoBase window, choose Always On Top.

A check mark appears next to the command, and a shadow appears around the window border to indicate that the InfoBase window is on top.

If you do not want the InfoBase window to be on top, choose Always On Top again, to deselect.

Moving Around In InfoBase

You can use the button bar to move around in the InfoBase. You can browse through topics, and go back to topics you've viewed previously. You can search for specific information or display the Contents. You can also choose a jump to go to a new topic.

Backtracking Through Topics

Use the Back () button to go back through the topics you have viewed, in the order in which you viewed them. If there is no previous topic to view, the Back button is dimmed. The record of topics you have viewed is removed each time you quit InfoBase.



To backtrack through Topics choose the Back button on the InfoBase button bar, or type the letter **b**.

You return to the previously viewed topic. The topic appears as you left it, unless you resized the window before backtracking.

Browsing Through Topics

If the browse buttons ( and ) appear in the InfoBase window, it means certain Topics have been grouped together in a sequence.

To view the next topic in the browse sequence, choose the  button on the InfoBase button bar, or press the period (.) key.

When you reach the last topic in the sequence, or if there is no browse sequence, the button is dimmed.

To view the previous topic in the browse sequence, choose the  button on the InfoBase button bar, or press the comma (,) key.

When you reach the first topic in the sequence, or if there is no browse sequence, the button is dimmed.

See also: Moving Around In InfoBase.

Displaying InfoBase Contents

Contents generally lists available topics. If you are viewing a topic and you want to return to Contents, use the Contents button.

To display InfoBase Contents from within InfoBase, choose the Contents button () in the button bar. or type **c**.

See also: Moving Around In InfoBase and Getting Help from JBA Applications.

Returning To A Topic You Have Viewed

You can use the History button to see a list of the previous 40 Topics you have viewed. To return to a topic, choose it from this list.

To display InfoBase Contents from within InfoBase:

1. In the InfoBase button bar, select the  button. Or type **t**.
2. Double-click the topic you want to return to (or select it and press **Enter**).

If necessary, use the scroll bar to see more topics. The History window stays open until you close it or quit InfoBase.

To close the History window: double-click the Control-menu box (). Or press ALT+F4.

See also: Moving Around in InfoBase and Scrolling Through A Topic.

Open Another InfoBase File

You can open a InfoBase file for any application that offers InfoBase. You do not have to be using the application to open its InfoBase file. For example, you can be working in Purchase Management and open the InfoBase file for Inventory Management to read about the Item Master File.

To open another InfoBase file:

1. From the File menu in InfoBase, choose Open.
2. In the File Name box, select the name of the InfoBase file you want to open. If the file you want to open is not in the current directory, select a different directory in the Directories box and choose the OK button. Then select an InfoBase file in the File Name box. If the file you want is not on the current drive, open the Drives box, and select a drive. Then select an InfoBase file in the File Name box.
3. Choose the OK button.

See also: Getting Help From JBA Applications.

Print A Topic

You can print any Topic. A topic prints on the default printer. If you have installed more than one printer, you can make any of them the default printer. You can also change the options for the default printer.

To print the current Topic: from the File menu in InfoBase, choose Print Topic.

To change printers and printer options:

1. From the File menu in InfoBase, choose Print Setup.
2. Select the printer you want to use.
3. To change the default printer options, choose the Setup button. The options vary, depending on the printer you select.
4. Select the options you want.
5. Choose the OK button to close the printer's Setup dialogue box.
6. Choose the OK button.

For help with the Setup dialogue box, choose the Help button or press **F1** while using the dialogue box.



Note: You cannot print information that is in a pop up window.

Scroll Through A Topic

If the information in a Topic doesn't fit in the window, use the scroll bar.

To scroll through a Topic, click one of the scroll arrows to scroll one line at a time, or drag the scroll box to scroll quickly through a topic, or use the arrow keys to scroll up or down.

To scroll up or down, one window at a time, click above or below the scroll box in the scroll bar, or use the Page Up and Page Down keys.

See also: Moving Around In InfoBase.

Search For A Topic

You can find information quickly by using the Search button in the InfoBase window. The Search button opens the Search dialogue box, where you select a word that you want to search for. All Topics associated with that word are listed, and you can select one to view. For example, to find out how to save a file, you could select Save from the list. Topics that have the word Save associated with them would then be listed in the Search dialogue box.

To search for InfoBase information:

1. In the InfoBase button bar, choose the Search button. Or type **s**.
2. Select the word or phrase you want to search for. When you start typing, the words that most closely match the text you type are displayed.
3. Choose the Show Topics button.
4. Select the topic you want to view. If necessary, use the scroll bar to see more topics.
5. Choose the Go To button.

See also: Moving Around In InfoBase.

View An Application And InfoBase Together

When you use InfoBase, you may want to change the size of the InfoBase window and move it so that you can see both the InfoBase window and your application window. By positioning windows so that they are both visible, you can follow step-by-step procedures without having to switch between windows. Another way to make sure that you can see both InfoBase and your application is to keep the InfoBase window on top of the application window while you work.

To change the size of the InfoBase window: drag the corner or border of the window until the window is the size you want. Or press ALT, SPACEBAR to open the Control menu and use the Size command to change the size of the window.

To change the size of the InfoBase window: drag the title bar of the window to the new location. Or press ALT, SPACEBAR to open the Control menu and use the Move command to move the window. For more information on moving and sizing windows, see your Windows documentation.

See also: Keeping InfoBase On Top Of Other Windows.

Commands And Buttons

This section details the use of Menu Commands and the InfoBase Buttons.

File Menu Commands

The File option on the InfoBase main menu displays the following options:

Open

Opens a InfoBase File.

Print Topic

Prints the topic that is in the InfoBase window. You can only print entire topics. To print entire sections of the InfoBase file you should use the print option on the Navigator. The Navigator is accessed by selecting the Navigator button on the InfoBase toolbar.

Print Setup

Sets printer options before printing a topic. You can select a printer and set or change options for the printer. The options available depend on the type of printer selected.

Exit

Quits Help and saves any annotations or bookmarks you created.

Edit Menu Commands

Copy

Copies the text of the current topic to the Clipboard. From the Clipboard, you can paste the text into another application or document.

Annotate

Adds text to the current topic. Annotations are marked with a paper-clip icon, which appears in front of the topic heading.

Bookmark Menu Commands

Define

Places a bookmark in the current topic or removes a bookmark from any topic. The name you specify for the topic appears on the Bookmark menu.

List of Bookmark Names

Appears after you have defined a bookmark. From this list, you can choose the bookmark for the topic you want to display in the InfoBase window.

More

Appears when you have defined more than nine bookmarks. Displays the complete list of bookmark names you have defined.

Help Menu Commands

How to Use InfoBase

Displays Contents for Getting Started With System 21. Choosing this command is the same as pressing F1 while you are using Client Workspace.

Always on Top

Causes all InfoBase windows to appear on top of other windows. After you choose this command, a shadow appears around the window border to indicate that the InfoBase windows are on top.

About Help

Displays version, mode, and copyright information about System 21.

InfoBase Buttons

InfoBase buttons are located along the top of the Help window and enable you to move around easily in InfoBase. If a feature is not available, its button name is dimmed.



Note: Some applications may have additional Help buttons not described in the following table. The browse buttons appear only if the application's Help offers this feature.

<u>Button</u>	<u>Function</u>
Contents	Displays Help Contents for the application you are using.
Search	Lists all the words you can use to search for topics in the application's Help. By typing or selecting one of these words, you can search for and go to a specific Help topic.
Back	Displays the last topic you viewed. You move back one topic at a time in the order you viewed the topics.
History	Displays the last 40 topics you have viewed in the Windows session. The most recent topic viewed is listed first. To revisit a topic, double-click it.
	Displays the previous topic in a series of related topics, until you reach the first topic in the series. The button is then dimmed.
	Displays the next topic in a series of related topics, until you reach the last topic in the series. The button is then dimmed.

To choose an InfoBase button, select the button you want, or type the letter underlined in the button.

